Phase 2: User Research

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Step 1

User Interviews + Surveys

Based on insights from **user interviews and** survey responses across groups, several clear themes emerged.

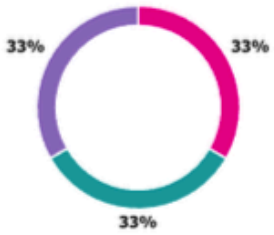
Users appreciate access to diverse perspectives and the ability to find answers via search. However, recurring themes highlight declining trust, moderation dissatisfaction, and difficulty identifying high-quality answers.

S. No	Theme	What users asked for	User problem observed	Impact
1	Trust & Credibility	• Evidence-backed answers • Clear labeling (fact vs opinion) • Expert identification	Users struggle to determine which answers are reliable due to spam, misinformation, and opinion-heavy content	Declining trust → Users migrate to Reddit or AI tools for clearer answers
2	Moderation Transparency	• Clear explanation for bans • Fair content review • Transparent appeal process	Accounts and answers are removed without clear reasoning, leading to frustration among contributors	Contributor churn → Reduction in high-quality answer supply
3	Content Discovery & Structure	• One clear “best” answer • Better categorization • Duplicate question merging	Users find multiple similar threads and long unstructured discussions overwhelming	Increased cognitive load → Lower engagement and retention
4	Quality Control	• Better spam filtering • Reduced promotional content	Feed contains low-signal or biased content	Perception of platform decline since 2017–2020
5	Technical Reliability	• Stable app performance • No freezing while typing	App crashes and content loss discourage long-form	Reduced answer creation → Weakens ecosystem

			contributions	
6	Entry Friction	• Easier reading without forced login • Less aggressive app prompts	Login gating interrupts answer consumption	Friction in SEO-driven traffic → Missed conversion opportunities

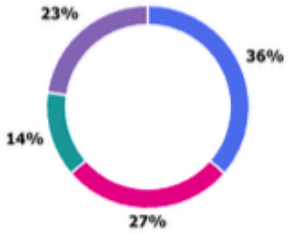
1. How often do you use Quora?

Daily	0
Few times a week	4
Few times a month	4
Rarely	4



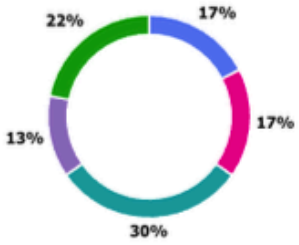
2. Why do you primarily use Quora? *(select all that apply)*

Learning new topics / Research	8
Entertainment	6
Career advice	3
Asking personal questions	5
Writing answers	0



3. What keeps you coming back to Quora? *(select all that apply)*

Quality answers	4
Specific niche topics	4
Personal stories	7
Notifications	3
Curiosity-driven feed	5



4. Compared to other platforms (Reddit, YouTube, Google), how trustworthy do you find Quora?

2.92

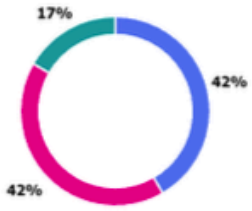
Average Rating

1 2 3 4 5



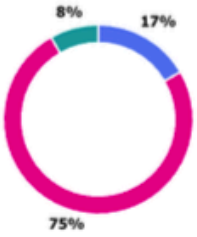
6. Do you find it hard to identify the BEST answer in long threads?

Yes	5
Sometimes	5
No	2



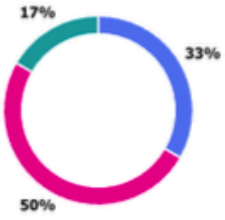
7. Have you encountered misleading or factually incorrect answers?

Very often	2
Sometimes	9
Rarely	1
Never	0



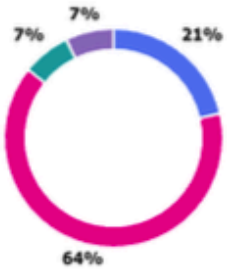
8. Do you feel upvotes always reflect answer quality?

Yes	4
Sometimes	6
No	2



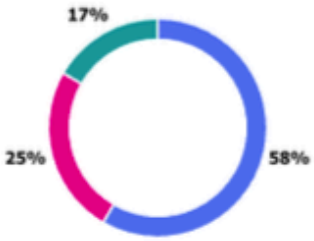
9. Do you usually read full answers or just skim?

Read fully	3
Skim	9
Only read top answer	1
Rarely read fully	1



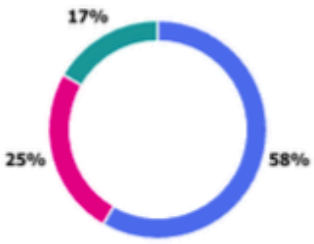
10. Would you find it useful if Quora automatically summarized long answer threads?

Yes	7
Maybe	3
No	2



11. Would you prefer AI to suggest better phrasing before posting a question?

Yes	7
Maybe	3
No	2



12. Would you trust an AI label that shows:

"Expert answer"	0
"Evidence-backed answer"	11
"Opinion-based answer"	1



Step 2

SWOT Analysis

Strengths

From my research, users value Quora for its vast knowledge base, diverse perspectives, and ability to find answers quickly through search. Many users appreciate the platform's accessibility via the web and its strong presence in Google search results. The concept of open Q&A and exposure to real human experiences continues to be a core strength.

Users particularly appreciate:

- Access to niche and personal questions
- Exposure to multiple viewpoints
- Informative content across varied domains
- Community-driven responses

These strengths position Quora as a scalable knowledge-sharing platform with strong discoverability.

Here are some samples of user feedback in Google Play store.

Weakness

A major weakness identified is declining trust in content quality and moderation transparency. Users frequently report difficulty distinguishing credible answers from opinion-based or spam content. Additionally, contributors express frustration over inconsistent bans and lack of explanation when content is removed.

Technical issues such as app freezing, crashes while typing, and forced login prompts also reduce user confidence.

Key recurring complaints:

- Spam and unverified content
- Accounts banned without clear reasoning
- Duplicate questions and poor categorization
- Difficulty identifying the best answer

- Forced app download or login gating

These weaknesses directly impact trust, contributor retention, and overall user satisfaction.

Here are some samples of user feedback in Google Play store.

Opportunities

Findings suggest a strong opportunity for Quora to evolve from a traditional Q&A platform into an AI-enhanced credibility-driven knowledge system.

Enhancing answer verification, moderation transparency, and content structuring could significantly improve user trust without changing the core product experience.

User-driven opportunity signals include:

- ❖ 15+ users requested clearer evidence-backed answers and better quality filtering.
- ❖ Multiple users expressed frustration with moderation opacity and unfair bans.
- ❖ Several users highlighted difficulty finding structured, high-quality responses in long threads.

There is a clear opportunity to introduce:

- AI-based credibility scoring
- Opinion vs fact labeling
- Thread summarization and canonical answers
- Transparent moderation explanations

These improvements could restore trust while strengthening competitive positioning.

Here are some samples of user feedback in Google Play store.

Threats

Users frequently compare Quora to competitors such as:

- Reddit
- Stack Overflow
- Medium
- AI-driven tools like OpenAI (ChatGPT)

When users struggle with trust, quality, or moderation concerns, they are more likely to migrate to platforms perceived as either more authentic (Reddit) or more structured and direct (AI assistants).

Additional risks include:

- ❖ Contributor churn due to moderation dissatisfaction.
- ❖ Reputation declines from misinformation complaints.
- ❖ Reduced retention if quality perception continues to drop.

If these structural issues are not addressed, Quora risks losing both high-quality contributors and high-intent knowledge seekers.

Step 3

Goal setting - Linking User Pain to Business Impact

S. No	User Problem	Leads to User behaviour	Business Impact / Metric affected
1	Users cannot easily identify trustworthy answers	Users cross-check on Google, Reddit, or AI tools instead of relying on Quora	• Low retention • Reduced session depth • Decreased trust score
2	Moderation feels inconsistent and opaque	Contributors stop posting or reduce long-form answers	• Supply-side decline • Lower content quality • Contributor churn
3	Duplicate threads & poor content structure	Users skim briefly and exit without deep engagement	• Low engagement rate • Reduced dwell time • Lower ad impressions
4	Spam & low-signal content in feed	Users disengage from feed browsing	• Reduced DAU/MAU • Lower ad revenue efficiency
5	Lack of interactive features (polls, reactions)	Search-driven users bounce without converting	• Low conversion rate • Missed new user acquisition opportunity

Chosen primary metric: **Retention** because

- Users still value the concept and knowledge base.

- Decline in trust is driving platform leakage.
- Improving answer credibility increases repeat usage.

Goal statement: *Increase 30-day retention of high-intent search users in the top 5 knowledge categories by (5-10)% within 6 months by improving answer credibility visibility and reducing low-signal content exposure.*

Step 4

Personas - Bringing Users to Life

Persona 1: The Execution-Driven Professional

Identity	• Name: Rakshith • Role: IT professional • Age: 26 • Location: Bengaluru • Tagline: “I need answers I can trust and use immediately.”
Goals	• Get reliable, structured insights on career and product topics • Validate decisions using real-world experiences • Avoid spending time filtering low-quality content
Behaviours	• Searches Quora via Google for career or tech queries • Skims top 2–3 answers before deciding credibility • Cross-checks answers on Reddit or AI tools. • Occasionally bookmarks useful answers. • Rarely posts questions due to moderation concerns.
Frustrations	• Too many opinion-based answers. • Hard to identify expert or verified responses. • Duplicate threads with similar questions. • Spam or promotional content in feed.

Quote	“Don’t give me 20 opinions — give me one answer I can rely on.”

Persona 2: The Educator

Identity	• Name: Alisha • Role: Software Engineer • Age: 24 • Location: Mysuru • Tagline: “If I share something valuable, it shouldn’t disappear.”
Goals	• Share technical knowledge and personal insights • Build authority and visibility in his domain. • Engage in meaningful discussions
Behaviours	• Writes detailed answers occasionally. • Edits responses for clarity and formatting. • Check notifications for engagement. • Reports inappropriate content • Follows niche tech topics
Frustrations	• Answers getting deleted without clear explanation • Perceived inconsistent moderation. • High-quality content buried under spam • App freezing while writing long answers
Quote	“’m happy to contribute — just treat contributors fairly.”

Step 5

Problem Prioritization - Choosing P0

Problems identified

1. Users struggle to identify trustworthy, high-quality answers.

2. Moderation feels inconsistent and non-transparent.
3. Duplicate threads and poor content structure overwhelm users.
4. Spam and low-signal content in feed.
5. Forced login / app prompts interrupt answer consumption.

Score with PIF (Population + Intensity + Frequency)

Problem	Population	Intensity	Frequency	PIF score
Users cannot identify trustworthy answers	5	5	4	14
Moderation feels inconsistent	3	5	3	11
Duplicate threads & poor structure	4	4	4	12
Spam & low-signal feed content	4	4	4	12
Forced login / app prompts	3	3	3	9

Strategic filters

It links directly to the chosen business goal ➜ **30-day retention improvement**.

- When users trust answers ➜ they return.
- When users don't trust answers ➜ they cross-check elsewhere.
- Credibility is the foundation for engagement depth.

Product strength

It aligns with product strengths because Quora has -

★ Massive searchable knowledge base
★ Strong SEO presence & discovery engine
★ Established topic-based structure
★ Large contributor ecosystem
★ High-intent search traffic

Scope

- It is solvable within reasonable scope because credibility visibility can be layered on top of existing answers without redesigning the entire platform.
- AI-based labeling and structured summaries can be piloted within selected high-intent categories (Career, Finance, Health).
- Ranking adjustments can be tested incrementally via A/B experiments.

P0 problem

Users struggle to identify trustworthy, high-quality answers.

Because

- Highest PIF score.
- Stronger retention link.
- Supported by user evidence.

Problem Statement

High-intent knowledge seekers on Quora are unable to confidently identify credible, high-quality answers due to opinion-heavy content, spam, and lack of evidence visibility. This reduces trust, increases cross-platform verification behavior, and negatively impacts 30-day retention and engagement depth.